19

FITTING

19.1 INTRODUCTION

The garment which fits well on body looks good. Often, when one does not have adequate knowledge of the garments made, do not fit well. Hence, it is essential for a tailor to know the reasons for the ill fit of any garment made. These reasons can be kept in mind while measuring and cutting the cloth so that a good fitting can be achieved. It is necessary to try on the garment before final finishing so that any defects in fitting can be taken care of.

19.2 OBJECTIVE

After reading this lesson, you will be able to:

- explain fitting in garments;
- identify and correct defects in fitting;
- give a good fitting to garments.

19.3 FITTING

Any garment which sits well on the body is said to have good 'fitting'. In order to get a good fitting, it is necessary to try on the garment before final finishing so that any defects in fitting can be identified and removed. A garment which does not have good fitting does not look good when worn. Defects in fitting could be because measurements were not taken properly. When a garment is tried on, these defects can be taken care of and the resultant garment will be a well fitting one. The garment may get mis-shapen if it is opened

up repeatedly for fitting. Hence, it is necessary to try on the garment before final stitching and finishing.

19.4 HOW TO GIVE FITTING

When a garment is tried on, see that it is done properly. The garment should be correct on all points of the body. If there are defects at any place, mark those places on the garment and correct the defects later on.

19.5 REASONS FOR FITTING DEFECTS

As mentioned above, the defects in fitting should be marked during trial and corrected later on. But more important is to know the reasons for these defects so that in future, these can be avoided. A tailor learns through experience what these reasons could be and the more experienced a tailor is, the lesser will be fitting defects in the garments he makes. Fitting defects generally occur due to the following reasons -

1. Poor Cutting

Defects may occur if one has not been cautious during cutting of cloth, if the lay out had not been properly inspected before cutting or if one has not been careful while cutting curved areas. Experience helps in proper cutting. One has to carefully inspect the cloth before cutting. In this way majority of defects can be avoided by careful cutting.

2. Poor Stitching

A garment will have a poor fitting if the cutting and stitching is defective. Even if one has cut the cloth properly, but the garment is poorly stitched, it will have defects in fitting, hence, one must be very careful while working, to avoid defects in the garment.

3. Wrong marking

Sometimes it may happen that markings are made on the garment in order to rectify some defect. But in the process of trying to correct one defect, some other defect arises. This may happen because the marking placed for defect correction may be wrongly marked.

4. Cutting with wrong layout

If the layout on the cloth is not correct and the cloth is cut without allowances for seams and turnings, the garment is bound to be defective.

5. Customers preferences

Sometimes, even if the garment is well made, it may not be to the personal liking of a customer. Every person has preferences and these must be clearly asked for before stitching so that later on, the garment fits the person to his or her liking.

6. Fabric

The choice of fabric sometimes leads to fitting defects. For example, if two salwars are made one of cotton cloth and other with satin, with the same measurements, the one made of cotton cloth will be well fitting but the one made of satin will be too long. This is because the weight of the satin pulls it down and it appears to be longer. Hence the tailor should have the knowledge that for such fabrics, the full length should be kept slightly less so that the final garment gives a good fit.

7. Inferior trimming

One should always use trimming of good quality. Use of poor quality trimming may give rise to defects in fitting.

8. Fussy customer

Some people are extremely fussy about their clothes. Hence, even clothes which are well made and well fitting may appear ill-fitting to them.

9. Differences between cutter and tailor

If the cutter and the tailor do not have a mutual understanding of how the other works, the resultant garment may have some defects.

10. Poor workmanship

A poor workman end up making a poor garment. Good training and experience is a must for a good tailor. Only then will they be able to make good garments.

11. Unshrunk fabric

If the fabric has not been soaked and shrunk before cutting, then after the garment is ready, and is washed, it will shrink and become smaller in size. This will lead to poor fitting.

12. Disregard of allowances for growth

When garments are made for people growing up, proper allowances have to be kept otherwise the garment soon becomes short/tight.

19.6 WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNT

In this lesson you have learnt about fitting. How to give fitting and about the reasons for poor fitting in garments.

DO AND SEE
Give fitting as directed.

19.7 TERMINAL EXERCISE

i) Describe in detail the reasons for poor fitting.